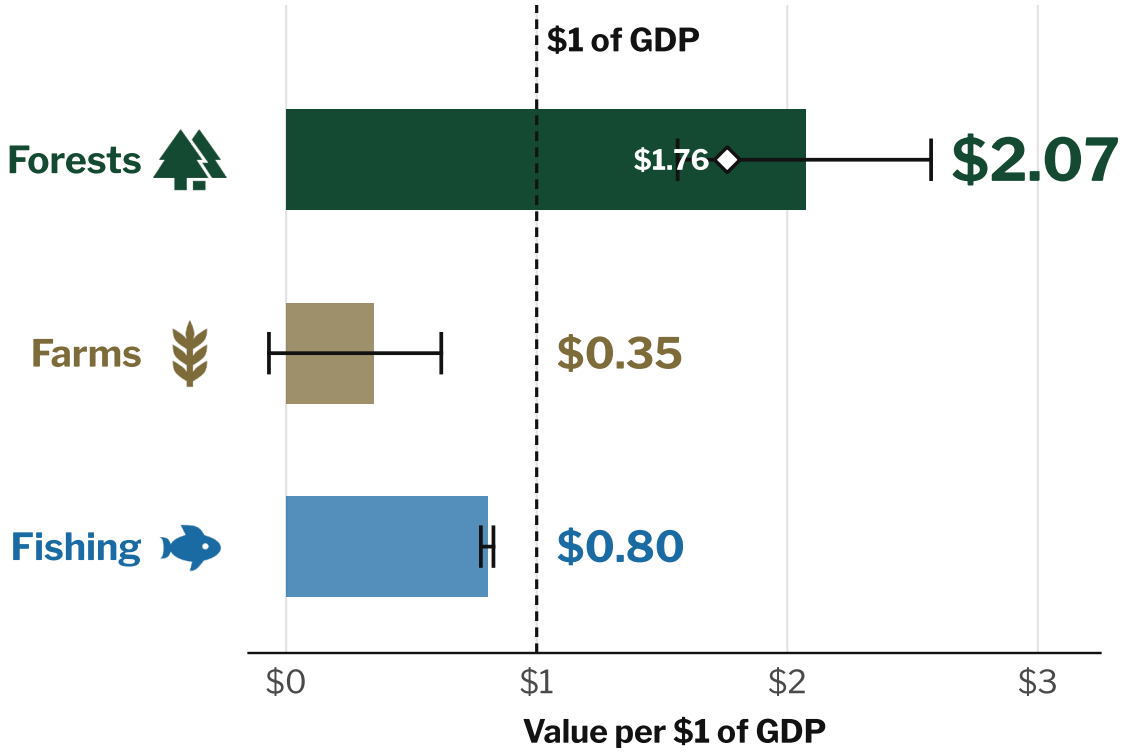
Forests are worth the most per dollar of GDP and get the least research money

U.S. farms, forests and fishing, each counted with its processing industries

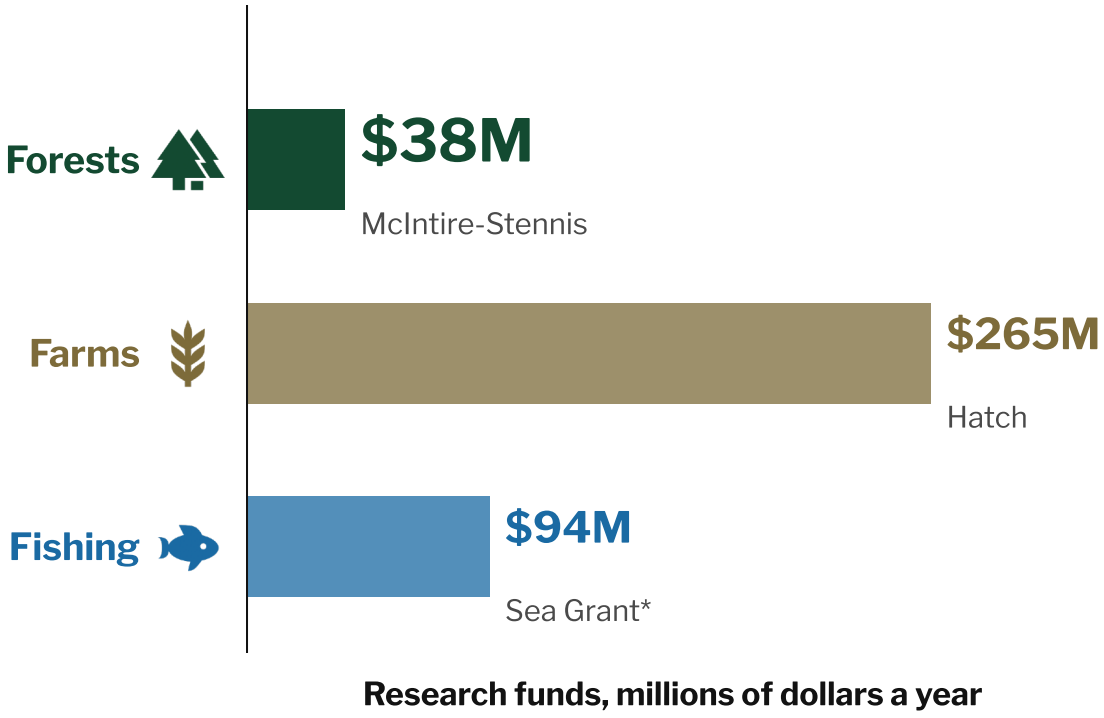
Forests are worth nearly twice their GDP

Counting nature's costs and benefits, per $1 of GDP, 2022



Yet forests get a seventh of farm funds

Federal formula funds for university research, 2024



Value per $1 of GDP: GDP less wear and tear, plus carbon at $120 a ton and nature's other costs and benefits, divided by GDP. Black bars: carbon at $51 to $190 a ton.
Diamond: forests without the clean air credit.
Each sector includes its processing (food, wood and paper, seafood). Clean air value covers all U.S. trees. *Fishing is estimated from landings, and Sea Grant also funds coastal work.
Data and methods: doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23122535. Weiskittel, Daigneault and Woodall, University of Maine.